

Course Outline

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June 5, 2026

I. INTRODUCTION

Civilization and The State of the World in the Anthropocene (Year: 2027)

1. The Anthropocene
2. State of the Earth: Year 2027
 - (a) The Atmosphere
 - (b) The Hydrosphere
 - (c) The Cryosphere
 - (d) The Biosphere
 - (e) The Lithosphere
3. State of the Humans: Year 2027
 - (a) Behavioral Organizing Principles
 - i. Money
 - A. Capital and Wealth
 - B. Debt-Based Economics
 - ii. Status and Power
 - iii. Religion
 - iv. Government and Empire
 - (b) Technology
 - (c) Population
4. State of Civilization
 - (a) Globalized
 - (b) Weaponized
 - (c)

II. APPROACH

0.1 System Analysis

1. Fundamental Systems Concepts and Perspectives

(a) System Components and Characterizations

(b) Systems Science

- i. classical (calculus-based) open/closed systems
- ii. set theory
- iii. graph theory
- iv. network theory
- v. cybernetics
- vi. information theory
- vii. game theory
- viii. complexity theory
- ix. decision theory
- x. queuing theory
- xi. theory of structure (the order of parts) and function (the order of processes)

(c) Mental Models

2. Spatial Scales

(a) Global

(b) Regional

(c) Local

3. Temporal Scales

(a) Past

(b) Present

(c) Future

4. Analytics

(a) Probability Models

(b) Statistical Models

(c) Agent-Based Models

(d) Time Series Models

0.2 Opportunity

1. External

- (a) Creating New Systems
- (b) Re-vamping Existing Systems
- (c) The Critical Systems
 - i. Economic
 - ii. Governance
 - iii. Cultural
 - iv. Artistic
 - v. Environmental
 - vi. Existential
 - A. Food
 - B. Water
 - C. Clothing
 - D. Shelter

2. Internal

- (a) Creativity
- (b) Intuition
- (c) Mind, Body, Spirit

III. TOPICS

0.3 Sustainability Concepts and Frameworks

1. Sustainability Concepts

- (a) Brundtland Commission
- (b) UN Sustainable Development Goals
- (c) Marshall and Toffel

2. Sustainability Frameworks

- (a) Ecological Sustainability
 - i. Ecosystem Services: Definitions and Metrics
 - ii. Global Ecosystem Health and Ecosystem Service Delivery
- (b) Social Sustainability
- (c) Economic Sustainability
- (d) Agricultural Sustainability

0.4 A Sustainable Biosphere

1. Functional Terrestrial and Aquatic Ecosystems

- (a) Necessary Inputs
 - i. Physical Resources
 - A. Space
 - B. Time
 - C. Flow
 - ii. Biological Resources
 - A. Reliable Primary Productivity
- (b) Necessary Outputs
 - i. Measurable Properties
 - A. Biodiversity
 - B. Energy and Material Recycling
 - ii. Emergent Properties
 - A. Adaptive Capacity
 - B. Resilience

0.5 A Sustainable Anthroposphere

1. Culture

- (a) Pillars of Belief
 - i. Reality and Imagination
 - ii. Identity Legacy
- (b) Open Cooperative Competition
 - i. Cohesion
 - ii. Energy
 - iii.

2. Power

- (a) Governance
- (b) Elites

3. Money

- (a) Consumption
 - i. Necessary
 - ii. Wants
- (b) Value vs Money vs Wealth
- (c) Economy and Trade